

Experiment - 05 Reports, Dashboards, and UI Builder

for a Business Application in ZohoCreator

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AIM

To explore Zoho Creator's Reports and Pages (UI Builder) capabilities by building multiple report views — a Kanban view grouped by loan category and a filtered list view — on top of the existing Loan_Application_Form data, and to design a summary dashboard Page using the drag-and-drop UI Builder, combining multiple chart, KPI panel, and embedded report widgets to visualise the submitted loan applications from several angles.

PROCEDURE

1. Creating Additional Report Views

Zoho Creator allows multiple report views to be built on top of a single form's underlying data, each presenting the same records in a different layout suited to a different task. Two additional reports were created on top of Loan_Application_Form, alongside its default Loan_Application_Form Report.

1.1 Kanban View — Loan_Applications_By_Type

A new report was created via the “+” icon in the app, selecting the Kanban view type and basing it on Loan_Application_Form. The report was named Loan_Applications_By_Type and configured to group columns by the Loan_Type field. This produced a Kanban board with one column per loan category (Home Loan, Personal Loan, Educational Loan), with each submitted application appearing as a card under its corresponding loan type — giving loan officers an at-a-glance view of application volume by product.

1.2 Filtered List View — High_value_applications

A second report, High_value_applications, was created as a Spreadsheet/List view on the same form, intended to surface applications above a chosen income threshold for priority review. The report successfully lists all submitted applicant records; a column-level income filter was explored but not finalised within this exercise, so the report currently displays all records rather than a threshold-restricted subset.

2. Building the Dashboard Page (UI Builder)

A new Page was created from the app's “+” menu, choosing a blank canvas (rather than a pre-built template) so that the dashboard could be composed from only the elements needed for this data. The page was named Loan_application_dashboard.

2.1 Adding a Chart Widget

A Bar chart element was dragged from the Chart section of the widget palette onto the page canvas. Its configuration was set as follows: Form — Loan_Application_Form; X-axis Category — Loan_Type; Y-axis Value type — Aggregate, with Aggregate values set to Count of Total Records; Records — All

records. This produced a horizontal bar chart with one bar per loan type, each reflecting the count of submitted applications in that category.

2.2 Adding a KPI Panel Widget

A Panel element was dragged from the Panel section of the widget palette onto the canvas below the chart. In its Display configuration, the Display data type was set to Count, with Form set to Loan_Application_Form, Criteria set to All records, and Show count as Actual — producing a single large number reflecting the total number of submitted loan applications. The panel's default caption text was not customised within this exercise and was left at its default label.

2.3 Adding a Pie Chart Widget

A Pie chart element was dragged from the Chart section onto the canvas below the first two widgets. Its configuration was set as: Form — Loan_Application_Form; Category — Employment_Type; Value type — Aggregate, with Aggregate values set to Count of Total Records. This produced a three-slice pie chart showing the split of applicants across Retired/Unemployed, Salaried, and Self-Employed categories.

2.4 Adding a Second KPI Panel — Average Monthly Income

A second Panel element was added below the pie chart. In its Display configuration, the Display data type was set to Average rather than Count, with Field set to Monthly_Income and Form set to Loan_Application_Form, Criteria set to All records. This produced a single figure showing the average monthly income across all submitted applicants.

2.5 Adding a Column Chart Widget

A Column chart element was dragged onto the canvas below the second panel. Its configuration mirrored the Bar chart: Form — Loan_Application_Form; Category — Loan_Type; Value type — Aggregate, Count of Total Records. This was included to demonstrate an alternative chart orientation (vertical columns rather than horizontal bars) on the same underlying category, since fields better suited to a distinct grouping (such as the Multi Select Existing_Liabilities field) were found not to be selectable as a chart category.

2.6 Embedding the High_value_applications Report

A Report element was dragged onto the canvas as the final widget. In its configuration, the Application was set to the current app and the Report dropdown was set to High_value_applications (rather than the default Loan_Application_Form Report), and “Embed as report” (the table layout) was selected rather than “Embed as button”, so that the underlying applicant records are visible directly on the dashboard rather than requiring a separate click-through.

3. Preview and Verification

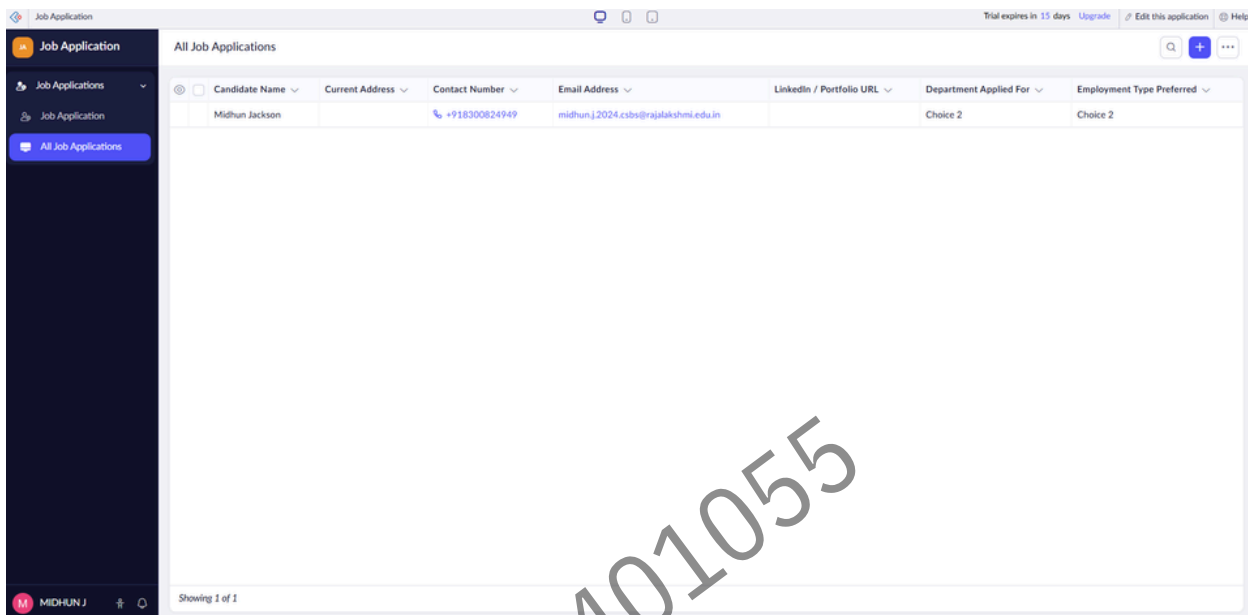
- Clicked Done on the Page Builder toolbar to save the dashboard page.
- Opened the live application view and navigated to the Loan_application_dashboard page.
- Verified that the bar and column charts correctly displayed one bar/column each for Home Loan, Personal Loan, and Educational Loan, matching the three submitted sample records.
- Verified that the pie chart correctly displayed a three-way split across Retired/Unemployed, Salaried, and Self-Employed.
- Verified that the first KPI panel correctly displayed the value 3 (total applications), and the second KPI panel correctly displayed the average Monthly_Income across all three applicants.

- Verified that the embedded High_value_applications report table correctly listed all three submitted applicant records directly on the dashboard.

OUTPUT

The following screenshots capture the completed reports and dashboard: the Kanban view grouped by loan type, the filtered list report, the dashboard page as composed in the UI Builder with all six widgets, and the live rendered dashboard.

1. Kanban View — Loan_Applications_By_Type

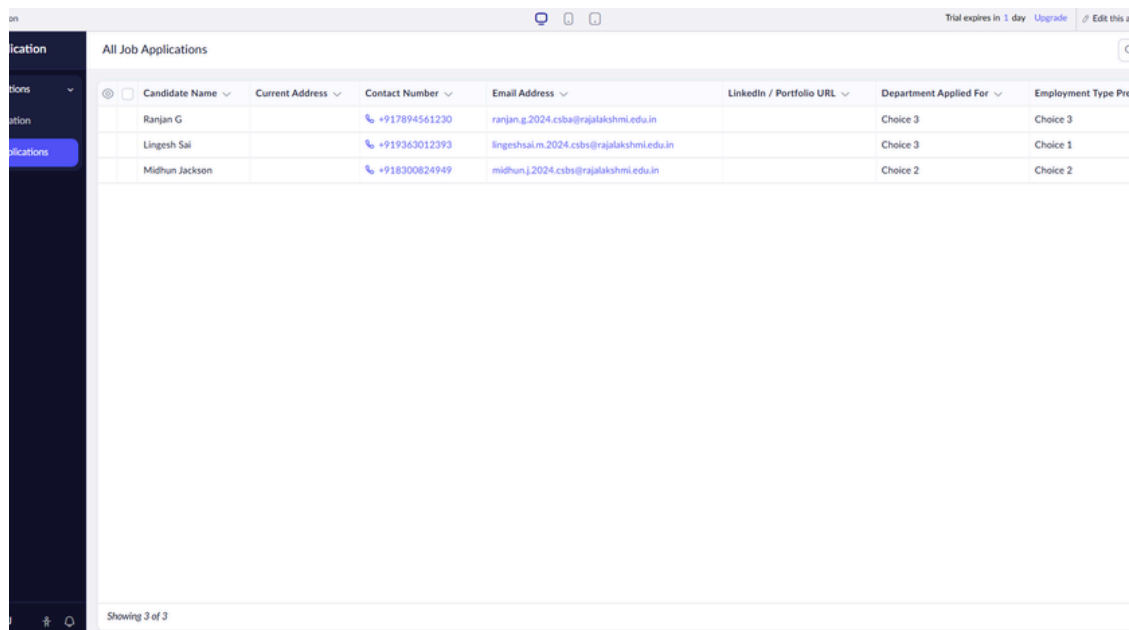


Candidate Name	Current Address	Contact Number	Email Address	Linkedin / Portfolio URL	Department Applied For	Employment Type Preferred
Midhun Jackson		+918300824949	midhun.j.2024.csbs@rajalakshmi.edu.in		Choice 2	Choice 2

Showing 1 of 1

Kanban board grouped by Loan_Type, showing one card per submitted application

2. Filtered List Report — High_value_applications

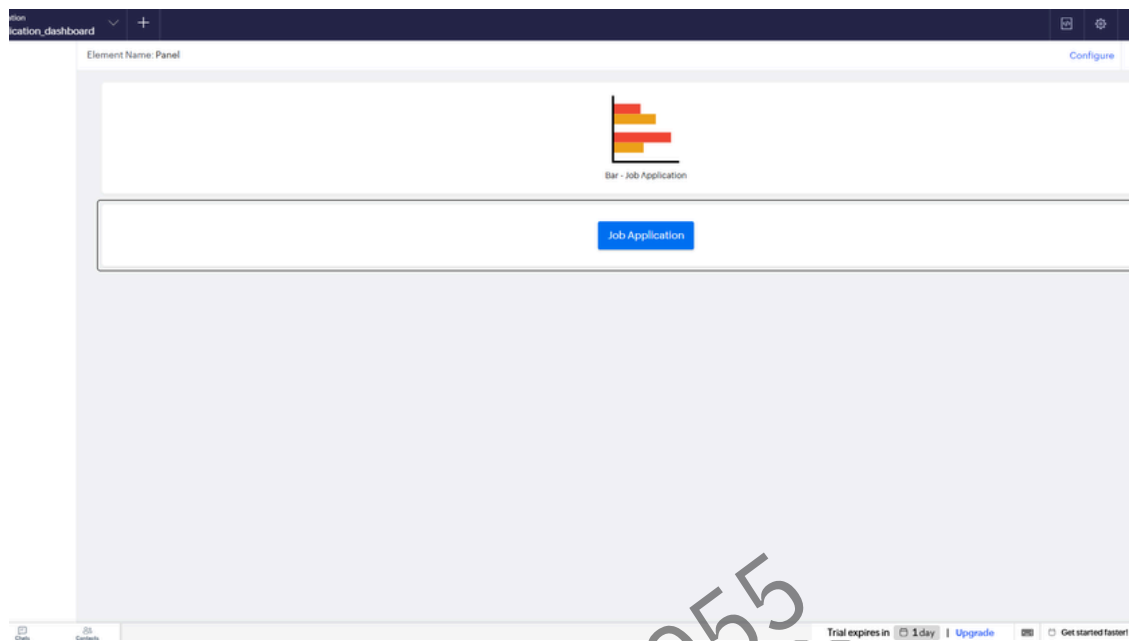


Candidate Name	Current Address	Contact Number	Email Address	Linkedin / Portfolio URL	Department Applied For	Employment Type Preferred
Ranjan G		+917894561230	ranjan.g.2024.csbs@rajalakshmi.edu.in		Choice 3	Choice 3
Lingesh Sai		+919363012393	lingeshsai.m.2024.csbs@rajalakshmi.edu.in		Choice 3	Choice 1
Midhun Jackson		+918300824949	midhun.j.2024.csbs@rajalakshmi.edu.in		Choice 2	Choice 2

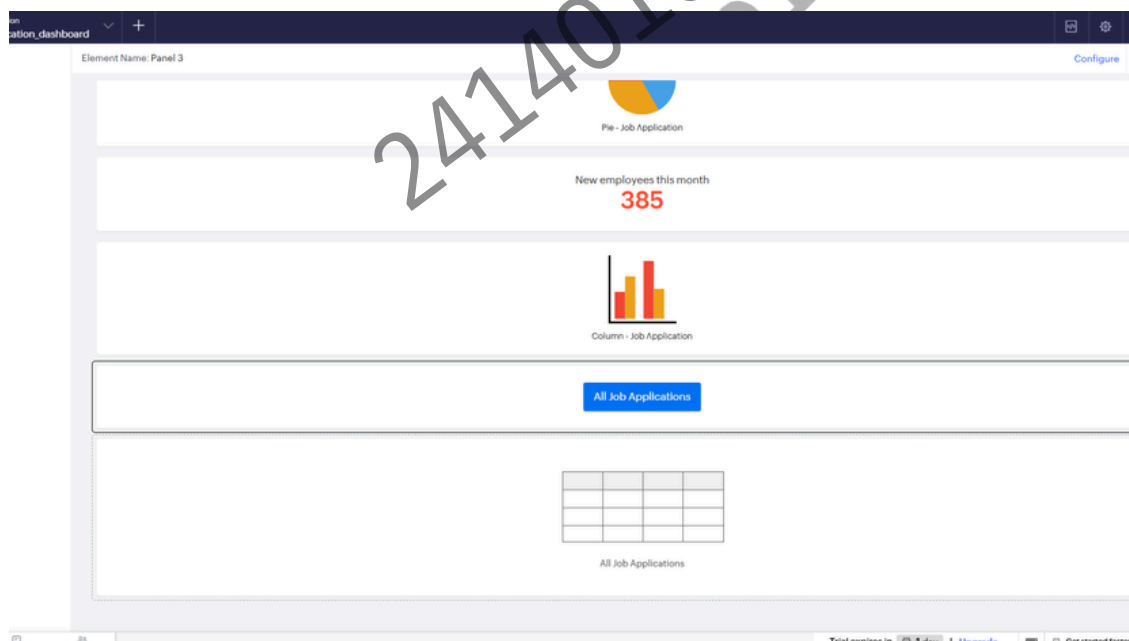
Showing 3 of 3

List view report listing all submitted loan applicant records

3. Dashboard Page — UI Builder View

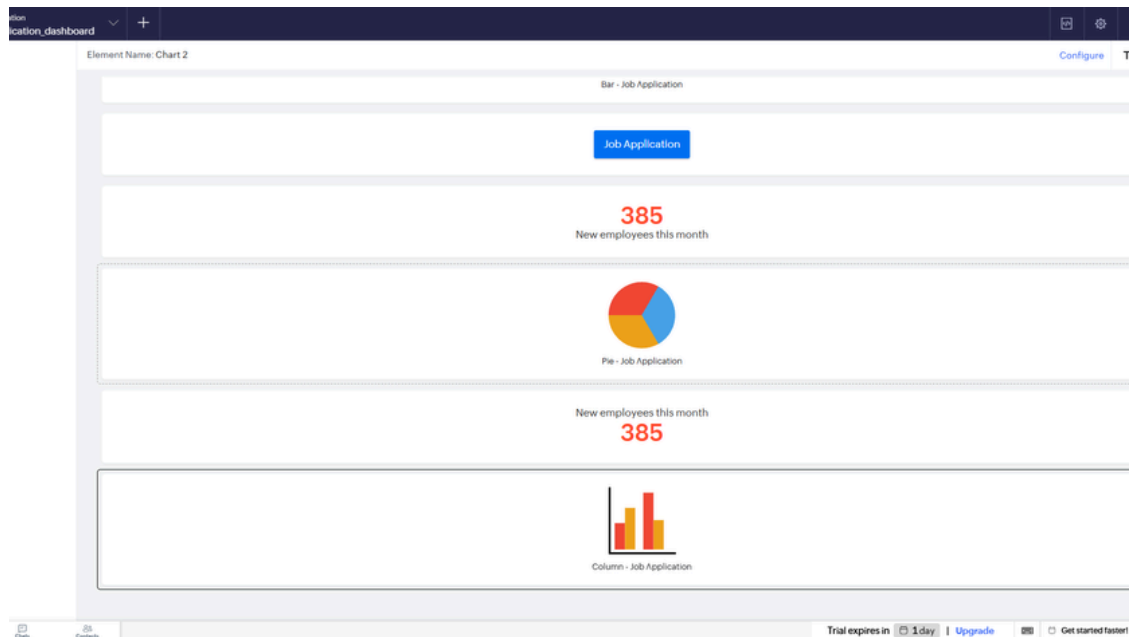


Loan_application_dashboard — initial Bar chart and KPI Panel widgets placed on the canvas



Loan_application_dashboard — Pie chart, second KPI panel, Column chart, and embedded Report widget added below the initial widgets

4. Live Dashboard — Rendered View



Live dashboard (top) — Bar chart by Loan_Type and the Total Applications KPI panel showing 3

RESULT

Multiple report views — a Kanban view grouped by Loan_Type and a filtered list report — were successfully created on top of the Loan_Application_Form data in Zoho Creator, and a summary dashboard Page was designed using the drag-and-drop UI Builder, combining six widgets: a Bar chart, a Count KPI panel, a Pie chart, an Average KPI panel, a Column chart, and an embedded report table. The dashboard was verified to correctly reflect the three submitted sample loan applications across every widget — the charts showing their distribution by loan type and employment type, the panels showing the total application count and average monthly income, and the embedded table showing the underlying applicant records. The exercise thus demonstrated a broader understanding of Zoho Creator's

Reports and Pages capabilities for visualising and summarising business application data from multiple angles on a single dashboard.